



GOVERNANCE

ROLE OF CIVIL SERVICE

MODULE - 7

INTRODUCTION

1 Civil service refers to the **body of government officials** who are appointed to the civil occupations that are **neither political nor judicial**.

2 The term bureaucracy has a wider meaning, it refers to the body of employees in a large-scale organisation. More specifically it is related to the body of such employees having **authority relationship within the organisation**.

3 It should be noted that the **bureaucracy do not refer to the elected politicians**, they refer only to the **appointed officials**.



THE NEED FOR CIVIL SERVICE

- 1 The modern life is filled with complexity and hence the importance of public administration in such a scenario is increasing.
- 2 This is because the need of the state to intervene in day-to-day activities of its citizens.
- 3 There is no aspect of the life of citizen which is out of purview from the administration.
- 4 The citizen comes in contact with some of the government agencies in their daily activities.
- 5 Many a number of activities now cannot be organised by citizens themselves privately, or as a village, or as even a community in cities.



THE NEED FOR CIVIL SERVICE

- 6 Thus the National, State and local governments have come forward to organise, and provide necessary **infrastructure facilities**, provide for effective production as well as facilitate the community type living.
- 7 For example, **railways** has been built for the transport of the raw materials and also to distribute the finished goods.
- 8 This also apart from **facilitating manufacturing**, helps in movement of people over long distances, that is an **important facet** of modern day living.
- 9 Similarly, **communication facilities** like telecommunication, microwave transmissions, satellite communication etc. all have to be provided for **meeting the need** and requirements of the **modern communities**.
- 10 And all these require massive men and material investment which is impossible to be provided by a small village community.



CHARACTERISTICS OF CIVIL SERVICE

1. ANONYMITY

- 1 Anonymity is an important characteristic of a public servant.
- 2 He should maintain anonymity while carrying out the services for the public.
- 3 The official acts are not carried out in their personal capacity, rather they are the agents of the government and carry out acts by virtue of the post they hold.



CHARACTERISTICS OF CIVIL SERVICE

2. CONSCIOUSNESS OF COMMUNITY SERVICE

- 1 The Public administrator works for the 'public'.
- 2 The act is carried out for the betterment of the community and not for deriving financial benefits out of them.



CHARACTERISTICS OF CIVIL SERVICE

3. PUBLIC RESPONSIBILITY

- 1 The administrators have to be held **publicly responsible** for their acts and actions.
- 2 They have to be **questioned** by the public regarding such aspects which will help the administration function on the right path.
- 3 In India and Britain this is achieved with the help of **Ministerial Responsibility** and other such facilities, which let people, the **press** and the **representatives** of the people **question** the actions of the administrators.



CHARACTERISTICS OF CIVIL SERVICE

4. LARGE-SCALE ORGANIZATION

- 1** It is the usual character of a government organisation, as it deals with numerous issues concerned with the state and its subjects.
- 2** Numerous problems arise because of this characteristic of administration. And this is not an essential character of administration.
- 3** Though smaller organisation exists, they exist within the larger organisation of the state.



CHARACTERISTICS OF CIVIL SERVICE

5. CONSISTENCY OF TREATMENT

- 1** This is an essential characteristic as the public official should not render unequal or favoured treatment to a section of people.
- 2** Everyone should be treated equally and without discrimination.
- 3** Unlike private service, favoured treatment cannot be accorded.
- 4** The public administration should follow the law and principles laid down by the Constitution in all aspects.



CHARACTERISTICS OF CIVIL SERVICE

6. PUBLIC INFORMATION

1 If the character of public responsibility has to work, then the public should have access to information regarding all such acts and functions of the administrators.

2 The secrecy is considered to be intolerable in a democratic setup, and hence the administrators have to take special steps to provide information to the public even without them demanding for such information.

3 Public administration is held to be everybody's business.



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